

TASK-THREE:

Design System

CART 444 WINTER 2026

DUE: March 17TH by 23H59

SUBMIT: TASK-03 (Moodle)

OPTION: Github Repo (URL) | Figma DS (URL) | PDF DOC.

DESCRIPTION:

The principal goal of TASK-THREE is the elucidation, development and documentation of a Design System (***Principles, Foundations, Components***) strongly aligned with your design or art practice and applied in the development of the TASK-FIVE Portfolio and beyond. The Design System should allow for the seamless formation of a unique Visual Design Language for use in your creative practice, along with unique deployments across a variety of chosen media channels (website, print, video, workshops etc.) ultimately to support, enhance and unify your Artistic Voice.

The **deliverable** for TASK-THREE, should be approached through a study of current Design Systems (Good Barber *, IBM Carbon, Adobe Spectrum or of your liking) in tandem with three - five inspirational websites. As suggested in the Design Systems slide package, one ideally approaches the task with either an ***Adopt or Adapt or Create mindset*** to implement the initial ***Foundations, Components*** set of the Visual Design Language & Design System – it is suggested that one opts for an ***Adopt mindset***. The ***Foundations, Components*** shall establish and delineate ideal practices pertaining to Typography, Colour, Layout, Spacing & Sizing, Motion, Elevation etc.

Principal References:

Design System Lecture Slides

Good Barber: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/foundations/>

IBM Design Language: <https://www.ibm.com/design/language>

Adobe Spectrum: <https://spectrum.adobe.com/>

Google Material #3: <https://m3.material.io/foundations>

TASK-THREE: Breakdown of Design System Requirements and Deliverables.

The elucidation, development and documentation of a Design System would contain at a minimum the following **sections**:

Guiding Philosophy & Principles Section (see IBM, Adobe)

Design System Layout:

Grid, Spacing, Responsive Design (or Adaptive Design), Layers,

Design System Graphic Elements:

Typography, Colour, Image Aspect Ratio, Iconography.

Design System UI Components:

Background, Text Field, Button, Dropdown, Checkboxes, Radio Button, Thumbnail and Form

Application of Design System

Portfolio Website Wireframes (Information Architecture and User Flow)

Portfolio Website Mockups & Templating based on Design System

Principles:

Identify your design system principles, how are these evoked principles experienced? Provide a descriptive paragraph which identifies, guides, and encapsulates the essence of your Visual Design Language and Design System.

Reference: <https://spectrum.adobe.com/page/principles/>
<https://www.ibm.com/design/language/philosophy/principles>

Grid:

Consider how Grids align elements and organize space to ensure a consistent layout across pages and devices. Grids also support responsiveness and the perception of balance within the compositions of pages or screens.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/grid/>

Spacing:

What is the ideal Spacing of these elements across different mediums, how do these Spacing properties interact with each other? Establish how compact (mobile), medium (ipad), expanded (desktop), large, and extra-large layouts and window size classes are impacted.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/spacing/>
<https://carbondesignsystem.com/elements/2x-grid/overview/>

Responsive Design (or Adaptive Design) Breakpoints:

Devices of different sizes and orientations need different layouts. Change in breakpoints takes advantage of device capabilities and user expectations. Explore breakpoints to direct attention to the action users want to take, adapt layouts to compact (mobile), medium (ipad), expanded (desktop), large, and extra-large window size classes.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/breakpoints/>

Layers:

Employment of a multi-layered composition or interface helps organize information – intentionally leads eye movement. It enhances the user experience, making compositions and interfaces more dynamic, flexible, and engaging.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/layers/>

Colour:

Primary and secondary colours along with tints, shades, backgrounds, and text colors. Expand on where each is used and how should they interact with each other? What colour text is acceptable on what colour background?

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/color/>
<https://carbondesignsystem.com/elements/color/overview/>
<https://m3.material.io/styles/color/system/how-the-system-works>

Typography:

For the Design System (Style Guide) deliverable: Establish how *hierarchy* is communicated through differences in font weight, size, line height, and letter spacing. Additionally organise styles into roles that are named to describe their purposes: Display, Headline, Title, Body, Label and Legal.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/typography/>
<https://m3.material.io/styles/typography/overview>
<https://carbondesignsystem.com/elements/typography/overview/>

Aspect Ratio:

The Aspect Ratio of an image or video impacts the look and feel of a composition or layout. Use a common 16:9, 4:3, 3:2, 2:1 or 1:1 aspect ratio when cropping images. These common aspect ratios should work well with your Grid foundation, they help create a visual rhythm —from UI components to signage, event spaces and beyond.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/images-aspect-ratios/>
<https://www.ibm.com/design/language/photography/tips-and-techniques#aspect-ratio>

Icons and Iconography:

Iconography consists of visual symbols that represent ideas, objects or narratives, and enable interactivity and simplify complex concepts. Icons provide a simple and effective way to communicate information and enhance the interface.

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/icons/>
<https://www.ibm.com/design/language/photography/tips-and-techniques#aspect-ratio>

Components:

Components are interactive building blocks for creating a user interface (patterns). They can be organised into categories based on their purpose: Action, containment, communication, navigation, selection, and text input.

Enumerate these essential **UI Components**: Buttons, Text Inputs (Form Elements), Checkboxes & Radio Buttons, Toggles, Dropdown Menu, Cards, Dialog Boxes, Progress, Tooltips and Alerts. Consider their use cases and how they fit within the design system ecosystem. How do they look, how do they function, and how do they interact with each other? Are there animations? Do states change on hover or press?

Reference: <https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/ui-components/>
<https://carbondesignsystem.com/components/overview/components/>

TASK-THREE: INSPIRATIONAL DESIGN SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATIONS.

Good Barber

<https://www.goodbarber.com/uxdesign/foundations/>

Mesh Design System

<https://www.meshdesignsystem.com/getting-started/design-principles>

Aalto University

<https://brand.aalto.fi/en/ds/tokens>

Others

<https://github.com/alexpate/awesome-design-systems>
<https://manual.louderthanten.com/>
<https://pulse.heartbeat.ua/design-tips/typography/>
<https://www.coop.co.uk/experience-library/foundations/>
<https://style-guide-statr.webflow.io/>